



BEFORE YOU BUY · A CALM CHECKLIST

5 questions to ask before buying *another* AI tool

Most teams don't need more tools — they need more confidence with the ones they have. Before the next licence, the next pilot, the next login, run through these five.

- 1 What decision or workflow will this actually change?**
If you can't name the work it improves, it's another login — not a capability. Tie it to a real task before you tie it to a budget line.
- 2 Who owns it after the pilot?**
A tool with no owner quietly becomes shelfware. Decide who runs it, who answers questions, and what “working” should look like in 90 days.
- 3 What happens to our data?**
Know what it trains on, where data goes, and what must never be pasted in. Write the do-not-paste rule down in plain English, before anyone needs it.
- 4 Does it fit the tools we already have?**
New tools should reduce sprawl, not add to it. Check it works with what the team already opens every day — or be honest that it replaces something.
- 5 How will we know it worked?**
Agree one measure before you buy: time saved, quality lifted, or risk reduced. A measure, not a vibe — and a date to check it against.

The honest version

The right answer is often “not yet” — or “use what we have, better.” That's usually where the fastest, calmest gains are. My 1-to-1 lessons are built for leaders: beyond the tool skills, you build a real understanding of AI and shape your own AI vision and action plan for the business.

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